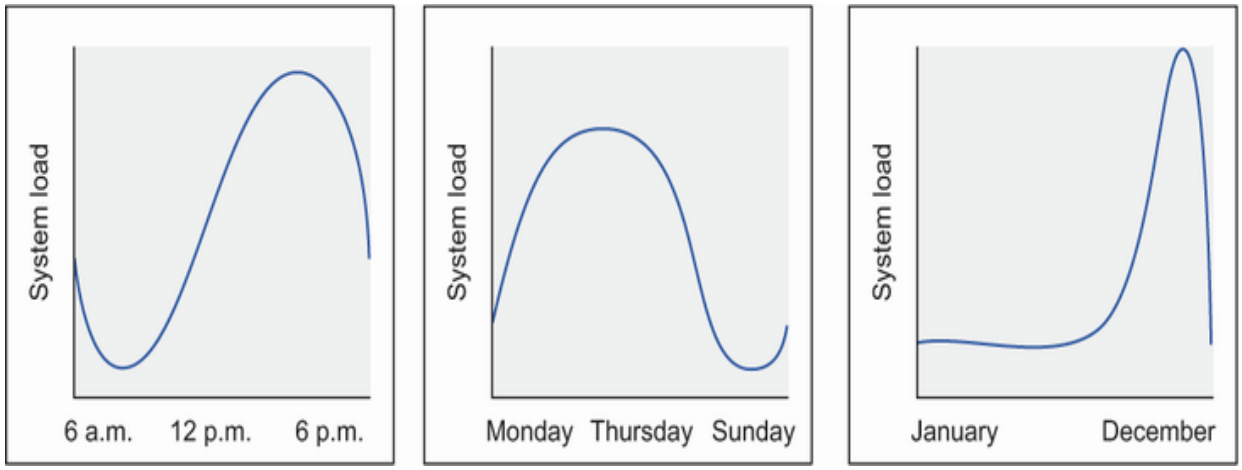


Figure 1.7 Seasonal traffic patterns for a web shop

The cloud has almost no capacity constraints. You no longer need to think about rack space, switches, and power supplies—you can add as many virtual machines as you like. If your data volume grows, you can always add new storage capacity.

Flexible capacity also means you can shut down unused systems. In one of our last projects, the test environment ran only from 7 a.m. to 8 p.m. on weekdays, allowing us to save 60%.

1.3.5 Built for failure (reliability)

Most AWS services are highly available or fault tolerant by default. If you use those services, you get reliability for free. Also, AWS provides tooling allowing you to build systems in a reliable way. It provides everything you need to create your own highly available or even fault-tolerant systems.